INGLÉS · NIVEL B1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Second Conditional en Inglés B1

Aprende el second conditional para hablar de situaciones imaginarias, dar consejos diplomáticos y expresar deseos poco probables.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Usar el second conditional para situaciones hipotéticas, imaginarias o improbables en el presente/futuro.

MODELO

If I had more time, I would learn to play the piano. / If I were you, I'd apologize.

Al terminar podrás

1. Forma el second conditional con If + past simple + would + infinitivo
2. Distingue second conditional (hipotético) de first conditional (real)
3. Usa were (no was) con todos los sujetos en cláusulas if formales
4. Aplica would para consejos diplomáticos con "If I were you, I'd..."

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve la práctica y corrige al final. Usa las tres pistas de audio de la lección web para imitar ritmo y entonación.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

El second conditional (If + past simple, would + infinitivo) expresa situaciones hipotéticas, imaginarias o poco probables en el presente o futuro. Es esencial para hablar de deseos, fantasías, consejos hipotéticos y para hacer el lenguaje más diplomático y educado.

Qué es el second conditional y para qué sirve

El second conditional describe situaciones que no son reales en el presente o que son muy poco probables en el futuro. La diferencia clave con el first conditional es la actitud del hablante: ¿cree que la condición es posible (1st) o hipotética/imaginaria (2nd)?

"If I won the lottery, I'd buy a house in the countryside." No espero ganar la lotería — es imaginario. Pero "If I save enough money, I'll buy a new laptop" — es realista y posible.

La regla del "were" en el second conditional

En inglés formal (y en exámenes de Cambridge, IELTS Writing Academic), se usa "were" con todos los sujetos en la cláusula if: "If I were taller..." / "If she were here..." / "If it were possible..." Esto viene del subjuntivo en inglés.

En conversación y en inglés americano informal, "was" es muy común: "If I was you..." Pero para los exámenes, usa siempre "were" — especialmente en la expresión fija "If I were you, I would..."

"If I were you, I would..." para dar consejos

Esta expresión es una de las más útiles en inglés para dar consejos de forma educada y empática. En lugar de decir "You should do this" (directo), dices "If I were you, I'd do this" (ponerte en su lugar).

"If I were you, I'd talk to your manager directly." / "If I were in your situation, I wouldn't ignore the problem." Es perfecta para conversaciones delicadas sobre trabajo, relaciones o decisiones importantes.

Would, could y might en la cláusula resultado

Puedes variar el nivel de certeza en el resultado con diferentes modales. Would expresa el resultado probable: "If I had a car, I would drive to work." Could expresa capacidad o posibilidad: "If I spoke better English, I could apply for that job." Might expresa menor probabilidad: "If I moved to London, I might feel lonely."

Esta variedad de modales es muy valorada en el IELTS Speaking Band 6+. Demuestra que controlas diferentes matices de significado.

Second conditional en conversaciones reales

"What would you do if you lost your job?" / "Where would you live if you could choose anywhere?" Estas preguntas hipotéticas son muy comunes en entrevistas de trabajo, en conversaciones sociales y en el speaking de IELTS.

También aparece en situaciones de negociación y diplomatismo: "If we received a larger order, we would offer a bigger discount." Usar second conditional en vez de first conditional suaviza la proposición.

¿Cómo se forma el second conditional en inglés?

Con "if + past simple, ... would + verbo base": "If I had more money, I would travel". La condición va en pasado (aunque hable del presente/futuro) y el resultado con "would". Con "be" se usa "were" para todas las personas: "If I were you…".

¿Cuándo se usa el second conditional?

Para situaciones hipotéticas, imaginarias o improbables en el presente o futuro: "If I won the lottery, I would buy a house" (no es probable). También para consejos: "If I were you, I would rest".

¿Cuál es la diferencia entre first y second conditional?

El first conditional plantea algo real y probable (present + will): "If it rains, I will stay home". El second plantea algo hipotético o improbable (past + would): "If it rained, I would stay home". Uno es posible; el otro, imaginario.

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

If + past simple, would + infinitive (same for all subjects)

Decide en este orden

1. Cláusula IF: past simple (aunque se refiere al presente o futuro hipotético).
2. Cláusula RESULTADO: would + infinitivo (sin "to") para todos los sujetos.
3. WERE especial: en inglés formal, "If I were you / If she were here / If it were possible" were para todos. En inglés coloquial "If I was" también se acepta.
4. Contraste con first conditional: "If I have time, I'll go" (posible) vs "If I had time, I'd go" (hipotético — no tengo tiempo).
5. Consejo con "If I were you, I would...": expresión fija y muy útil para dar recomendaciones educadas.
6. Could y might en lugar de would: "If I won the lottery, I could travel the world." / "...I might quit my job."

Condicional	Condición	Resultado
1st (real)	If + present simple	will + infinitive
2nd (hipotético)	If + past simple	would + infinitive
Consejo	If I were you	I'd (= I would)...

Errores frecuentes

× "If I would have more money, I would travel" "If I had more money, I would travel" — nunca "would" en la cláusula if.

× "If she was me" "If she were me" / "If I were her" — usa were en expresiones formales y en el examen.

× "I would to go" "I would go" — would va directamente con el infinitivo sin "to".

02 · MAPA VISUAL

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

If I had more free time, I'd learn to play the guitar.	Si tuviera más tiempo libre, aprendería a tocar la guitarra.
What would you do if you lost your phone?	¿Qué harías si perdieras tu teléfono?
If I were you, I'd apologize immediately.	Si yo fuera tú, me disculparía inmediatamente.
She would travel the world if she could afford it.	Ella viajaría por el mundo si pudiera permitírselo.
If we lived closer, we'd meet up more often.	Si viviéramos más cerca, nos veríamos con más frecuencia.
I'd be much fitter if I exercised more.	Estaría en mucho mejor forma si hiciera más ejercicio.
If you could speak any language, which would you choose?	Si pudieras hablar cualquier idioma, ¿cuál elegirías?
If the company hired more staff, we wouldn't be so overworked.	Si la empresa contratara más personal, no estaríamos tan sobrecargados.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

21 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

Situaciones hipotéticas

1. If I ___ enough money, I would travel around Asia. Opciones: had · have · would have · having

2. If I ___ you, I'd speak to the manager directly. Opciones: were · was · am · would be

3. What ___ you do if you ___ the lottery? Opciones: would / won · will / win · would / would win · did / win

4. If the salary ___ better, she ___ accept the offer. Opciones: were / might · is / will · would be / would · was / would have

5. I ___ much happier if I ___ less stressed at work. Opciones: 'd be / were · would be / am · am / were · 'd be / am

6. If traffic ___ so bad, people ___ use their cars less. Opciones: weren't / would · isn't / will · wouldn't be / would · wasn't being / did

7. She ___ play professional tennis if she ___ more time to practise. Opciones: could / had · can / has · would / would have · could / would have

8. ___ you accept the job if they offered it to you? Opciones: Would · Will · Do · Should

Deseos y consejos

9. If I _____ (be) you, I _____ (talk) to him directly about the problem. Opciones: were · was · am · would be / 'd talk · talked · will talk · would talked

10. If she _____ (not / have) to work, she _____ (dedicate) herself to painting. Opciones: didn't have · doesn't have · wouldn't have · hadn't had / would dedicate · will dedicate · dedicates · would have dedicated

11. If there _____ (be) more green spaces in the city, people _____ (feel) less stressed. Opciones: were · was · would be · are / would feel · will feel · feel · would felt

12. I _____ (can/speak) much better English if I _____ (live) in an English-speaking country. Opciones: could speak · can speak · would speak · speak / lived · live · would live · had lived

Una entrevista imaginaria

13. Journalist: "Imagine you could redesign your life completely. What _____ (you / change)?" Star: "If I _____ (can / choose), I _____ (become) a teacher. I think it's one of the most important jobs. If teachers _____ (earn) more money, more talented people _____ (choose) that career." J: "And if you _____ (not / be) famous, what _____ (you / miss) the most?" S: "Honestly? If I _____ (lose) my fame tomorrow, I think I'd miss the ability to make a positive difference."

Consejos hipotéticos

14. Some life advice: If I _____ (be) you, I _____ (not / ignore) that opportunity. A good mentor once told me: "If you _____ (want) to succeed, you have to take risks." I also believe that if people _____ (be) kinder to each other, the world _____ (be) a much better place.

Producción guiada

15. Escribe algo que harías si tuvieras ilimitado tiempo libre (If I had...).

_____

16. Usa "If I were you, I'd..." para dar un consejo sobre aprender idiomas o alcanzar una meta.

_____

17. Escribe qué podrías hacer si pudieras hablar perfectamente otro idioma (could).

_____

18. Escribe una pregunta de second conditional para hacerle a un amigo (What would you do if...?).

_____

Misión: Tu vida hipotética

19. Escribe qué harías de forma diferente si pudieras cambiar una cosa de tu situación actual.

_____

20. Da un consejo hipotético a alguien (amigo, colega o un político) usando "If I were you...".

_____

21. Describe un deseo o fantasía con "If I could..." o "If I had...".

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. had — Cláusula if past simple: "If I had enough money." (Situación hipotética: en realidad no tengo suficiente dinero).
2. were — "If I were you" es la expresión fija para consejos. Were es la forma correcta y más formal.
3. would / won — Would en la cláusula resultado + past simple en la cláusula if. "What would you do if you won?"
4. were / might — If + were (formal past of be) + might en resultado: "If the salary were better, she might accept."
5. 'd be / were — Would + infinitive en resultado / past simple (were) en cláusula if: "I'd be happier if I were less stressed."
6. weren't / would — If + weren't (past de be negativo) + would en resultado.
7. could / had — Could en resultado (capacidad hipotética) + had en cláusula if (past simple).
8. Would — Pregunta en second conditional: Would + sujeto + infinitivo? "Would you accept?" / "If they offered" past simple en cláusula if.
9. were / 'd talk — "If I were you" — usa were, no was, en la expresión de consejo. 'd talk = would talk. Resultado del segundo condicional.
10. didn't have / would dedicate — Cláusula if negativa didn't + have (past simple negativo): "If she didn't have to work." Resultado would + infinitivo: "she would dedicate herself to painting."
11. were / would feel — If + were (forma correcta para be en segundo condicional formal). Resultado would + feel (infinitivo): "people would feel less stressed."
12. could speak / lived — Could en el resultado expresa capacidad hipotética: "I could speak much better English." Cláusula if past simple: "if I lived in an English-speaking country."
13. would you change / could choose / 'd become / earned / would choose / weren't / would you miss / lost — Pregunta en second conditional: "What would you change?" — would + sujeto + infinitivo. If I could choose: past de can = could en la cláusula if (capacidad hipotética). 'd become = would become. Resultado del segundo condicional. If + past simple: "If teachers earned more money." Resultado would choose: "more talented people would choose that career." If + past (were weren't) para be: "If you weren't famous." Pregunta en second conditional: "what would you miss the most?" If + past simple: "if I lost my fame tomorrow."
14. were / wouldn't ignore / want / were / would be — If I were you: were es la forma correcta (subjuntivo). Was se acepta en informal. Resultado negativo wouldn't + ignore (infinitivo). If + want (present simple) o wanted (past simple hipotético). Aquí "want" en presente también es aceptable como dicho general. If + were (be en pasado): "If people were kinder." Resultado would be: "the world would be a much better place."
15. If I had unlimited free time, I'd learn three more languages. — Ejemplo: If I had more free time, I would read more and travel. / If I didn't have to work, I'd volunteer.
16. If I were you, I'd practice speaking English for at least 30 minutes every day. — Ejemplo: If I were you, I'd hire a private tutor. / If I were in your position, I'd negotiate a higher salary.
17. If I could speak Japanese perfectly, I could work as a translator in Tokyo. — Ejemplo: If I could speak Arabic, I could communicate with millions more people. / If you could speak French fluently, you could get a job in international organizations.
18. What would you do if you found a wallet full of money in the street? — Ejemplo: Where would you live if you could choose any city? / What would you change if you were the president?
19. If I lived closer to my workplace, I would have so much more free time. — Usa: If I [condición hipotética], I would [resultado]. Ej: If I earned more money, I would invest in my education.
20. If I were you, I wouldn't wait any longer — I'd apply for that scholarship now. — Usa: If I were you, I'd [acción]. Ej: If I were you, I'd start saving money now.
21. If I could speak ten languages, I would work as a UN interpreter. — Usa: If I could [fantasía], I would [resultado soñado]. Ej: If I had my own business, I would hire young talent.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.